



Flower petals play-mat

Make a comfy, colourful mat for baby's playtime. Use bright fabrics, choosing strongly contrasting colours to grab your baby's attention. Remember to wash and dry all the fabrics to pre-shrink them before cutting them out.

YOU WILL NEED ✿ tracing paper ✿ pencil ✿ scissors ✿ pins ✿ 14 scraps of fabric for petals, 20 x 38cm (8 x 15in) minimum per scrap ✿ two pieces of differently patterned main fabrics, 70 x 70cm (27½ x 27½in) each ✿ 33cm (13in) minimum length ruler ✿ tailor's chalk ✿ sewing machine ✿ matching thread ✿ pinking shears ✿ washable toy filling ✿ up to 14 washable squeakers, bells, rattles, pieces of cellophane, or other toy notions (optional) ✿ 2 pieces of wadding, each 70cm (27½in) square ✿ needle



1 Trace the petal template on page 233 onto the tracing paper and cut it out. Pin the template to the first piece of fabric and cut around it. Repeat, cutting out two petals from each of the 14 scraps of fabric so that you have a total of 28 petals.



2 Cut out a 64cm (25in) diameter circle from one of the pieces of main fabric. To do this, mark the centre of the fabric with chalk on the wrong side, then measure and mark a point 32cm (12½in) from the first mark. Continue in a clockwise direction, measuring and marking until you have a circle, then cut it out. Cut a matching circle from the other piece of main fabric.



3 Put two petals of different fabrics right sides together, then pin each pair. Using a straight machine stitch and matching thread, and leaving a 1cm (½in) seam allowance, sew around the rounded edge of each pair. Leave the straight edge open. Using pinking shears, trim the seam allowance to 5mm (¼in).